

Absolutely — **art** is a very strong polysemy/family target because your passage uses it in at least **two** related but contextually different ways:

> “...it appeared in an **art book** in the library.”

and later:

> “Of course, **art** is deeply personal...”

In the first, **art** refers to the **field/subject of visual artistic creation**. In the second, it refers more broadly to **creative works and artistic expression as a whole**.

Word family: **art / artist / artistic / artistically / artistry**

Base word: art

Related person: artist

Adjective: artistic

Adverb: artistically

Related noun: artistry

Useful compounds / expressions: work of art, art form, fine art, performing arts, visual arts, liberal arts, martial arts, state-of-the-art

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / attributive noun (名詞作前置修飾語)

Meaning 1 in your passage: **art = visual art as a subject/field — 藝術 ; 美術**

Your sentence:

> “It appeared in an **art book** in the library.”

Here **art** refers to:

> **the field of visual creative work such as painting, drawing, sculpture, etc.**

繁體中文 :

以繪畫、雕塑、素描等視覺創作為主的藝術領域 ; 美術 / 藝術

Natural translation:

> “It appeared in an art book in the library.”

「它出現在圖書館裡的一本**藝術 / 美術書**中。」

So:

> **art book = 介紹或展示藝術作品 / 藝術家的書**

Meaning 2 in your passage: **art = creative expression / creative works in general — 藝術；藝術創作**

Your sentence:

> “Of course, **art** is deeply personal...”

Here **art** means:

> **creative expression and artistic works considered broadly.**

繁體中文：

人透過創意、技巧和想像表達思想、感情或美感的作品 / 活動整體

Natural translation:

> “Art is deeply personal.”

「藝術本身非常**主觀而個人化**。」

So here:

> **art = 藝術這種創作與表達整體**

1. **art = creative activity/expression — 藝術；藝術創作**

The broad core meaning.

Practice 1

> “She has always been interested in **art**.”

「她一直對**藝術**很有興趣。」

Practice 2

> “Art can express emotions that are difficult to put into words.”

「**藝術**可以表達一些難以用語言說明的情感。」

****art = 透過創造力、技巧和想像表達思想、美感或情感的活動 / 領域****

2. ****art = visual art (美術) — 視覺藝術 ; 美術****

A common narrower use.

Practice 3

> “He studied ****art**** at school.”

「他在學校修讀****美術 / 藝術****。」

Practice 4

> “The museum has a large collection of modern art.”

「博物館收藏了大量現代****藝術作品 / 美術作品****。」

****art — visual = 繪畫、雕塑、版畫、攝影等主要透過視覺呈現的藝術****

3. ****art = artworks collectively — 藝術品 ; 藝術作品****

A major noun use.

Practice 5

> “The gallery sells contemporary ****art****.”

「這間畫廊出售當代****藝術作品****。」

Practice 6

> “There is a lot of art on the walls.”

「牆上掛著很多****藝術品 / 畫作****。」

****art = 藝術家創作出來的作品作為整體，通常不可數****

Important:

> art = 藝術作品整體

> a work of art = 一件藝術品

Normally not:

> *an art* ✗
> for one artwork.

4. **a work of art = individual artistic creation — 一件藝術作品**

Practice 7

> “The painting is a remarkable **work of art**.”

「這幅畫是一件出色的**藝術作品**。」

Practice 8

> “The sculpture is considered a major work of art.”

「這座雕塑被視為一件重要的**藝術品**。」

work of art = 一件個別的藝術創作

This is the normal countable expression.

5. **art = skill / technique requiring practice — 技巧；技藝**

A genuinely distinct figurative meaning.

Practice 9

> “There is an **art** to arranging flowers.”

「插花是有一套**技巧 / 技藝**的。」

Practice 10

> “Good teaching is an art.”

「好的教學是一門**藝術 / 技巧**。」

art = 需要經驗、判斷、技巧和細膩掌握才能做好的能力

Here **art** does not necessarily mean fine art.

6. **the art of + activity —的藝術 / 技巧**

A very common pattern.

Practice 11

> “She has mastered **the art of conversation**.”

「她掌握了**談話的技巧 / 藝術**。」

Practice 12

> “The book explains the art of growing herbs in small spaces.”

「這本書講解在小空間種香草的**技巧**。」

the art of X = 把某件事做得熟練、細緻、恰到好處的技巧

Natural Chinese often uses:

* 技巧

* 藝術

* 訣竅

depending on context.

7. **art = craft / learned human skill (傳統 / 學術) — 技藝 ; 技術**

A broader historical/academic sense that still survives in expressions.

Practice 13

> “Medicine was once described as both a science and an **art**.”

「醫學曾被形容為既是一門科學，也是一門**技藝**。」

Practice 14

> “The art of navigation developed over centuries.”

「航海**技術 / 技藝**經過多個世紀發展。」

****art = 人透過學習與實踐掌握的一套技能或技藝****

This is broader than modern “fine art”.

8. ****the arts = creative disciplines collectively — 藝術界；各類藝術****

Plural ****arts**** has an important collective meaning.

Practice 15

> “The government increased funding for ****the arts****.”

「政府增加對****藝術界 / 藝術活動****的資助。」

Practice 16

> “She has worked in the arts for many years.”

「她在****藝術界****工作了很多年。」

****the arts = 音樂、戲劇、舞蹈、繪畫、文學等藝術領域整體****

9. ****visual arts = 視覺藝術****

Practice 17

> “Painting and sculpture are part of the ****visual arts****.”

「繪畫和雕塑都屬於****視覺藝術****。」

Practice 18

> “She studied visual arts at university.”

「她在大學修讀****視覺藝術****。」

****visual arts = 主要透過視覺形式呈現的藝術類別****

Examples:

- * painting
- * sculpture
- * photography
- * printmaking

10. **performing arts = 表演藝術**

Practice 19

> “Dance is part of the **performing arts**.”

「舞蹈屬於**表演藝術**。」

Practice 20

> “The school has a strong performing arts programme.”

「這間學校有很完善的**表演藝術課程**。」

performing arts = 透過現場 / 表演形式呈現的藝術

Examples:

- * drama
- * dance
- * music

11. **fine art / fine arts = 純藝術；美術**

A useful academic/art-world compound.

Practice 21

> “She studied **fine art** in London.”

「她在倫敦修讀**純藝術 / 美術**。」

Practice 22

> “The museum focuses on the fine arts.”

「這間博物館主要收藏和展示**美術 / 純藝術**。」

****fine art(s) = 主要以審美、創意和藝術表達為目的的藝術，例如繪畫、雕塑等****

Contrast with:

- * applied arts
- * commercial design

12. ****applied art / applied arts = 應用藝術****

Practice 23

> “Furniture design can be considered an ****applied art****.”

「家具設計可以被視為一種****應用藝術****。」

Practice 24

> “Applied arts combine aesthetics with practical function.”

「****應用藝術****把美感與實際功能結合。」

****applied arts = 把藝術設計應用於具有實際用途的物件 / 產品上的藝術****

Examples:

- * ceramics
- * furniture
- * textile design
- * decorative design

13. ****liberal arts (教育) — 博雅教育；人文及通識學科****

A highly useful lexicalized academic compound.

Practice 25

> “She studied at a ****liberal arts**** college.”

「她在一所****博雅學院****就讀。」

Practice 26

> “A liberal arts education covers a broad range of subjects.”

「**博雅教育**涵蓋廣泛學科。」

liberal arts = 強調廣泛人文、社會科學、自然科學等基礎教育的學術傳統

Important:

> liberal arts ≠ only “藝術科”

This is an opaque compound learners often misread.

14. **martial arts (運動 / 技藝) — 武術**

Another highly lexicalized compound.

Practice 27

> “He has practised **martial arts** since childhood.”

「他從小就練習**武術**。」

Practice 28

> “Judo is a martial art.”

「柔道是一種**武術**。」

martial arts = 各種格鬥、防身或戰鬥技巧體系

Here **art** preserves the older idea of:

> practiced skill / discipline.

15. **art form = 藝術形式 ; 藝術類型**

Practice 29

> “Photography is now widely accepted as an **art form**.”

「攝影現在廣泛被視為一種**藝術形式**。」

Practice 30

> “Dance is one of the oldest art forms.”

「舞蹈是最古老的**藝術形式**之一。」

art form = 一種具有自己方法、風格和傳統的藝術表達形式

16. **artist = person who creates art — 藝術家；美術創作者**

Practice 31

> “Monet was a French **artist**.”

「Monet 是一位法國**藝術家**。」

Practice 32

> “The artist experimented with light and colour.”

「那位**藝術家**嘗試運用不同的光線和色彩。」

artist = 創作藝術作品的人

Depending on context:

* 畫家

* 藝術家

* 表演藝術工作者

17. **artist = performer / entertainer (娛樂) — 藝人；表演者**

A broader modern use.

Practice 33

> “Several international **artists** performed at the festival.”

「幾位國際**藝人 / 表演者**在音樂節演出。」

Practice 34

> “She is a recording artist.”

「她是一位**錄音歌手 / 音樂藝人**。」

****artist = 從事音樂、演出或其他創意表演工作的專業人士****

So ****artist**** does not always mean painter.

18. ****artistic = relating to art — 藝術的；藝術方面的****

Practice 35

> “The city has a rich ****artistic**** tradition.”

「這座城市有豐富的****藝術傳統****。」

Practice 36

> “She has strong artistic interests.”

「她對****藝術方面****有濃厚興趣。」

****artistic = 與藝術創作、藝術家或藝術活動有關的****

19. ****artistic = creative / aesthetically skilled — 有藝術天分的；有美感的****

Practice 37

> “She is very ****artistic****.”

「她很有****藝術天分 / 藝術細胞****。」

Practice 38

> “The arrangement has an artistic quality.”

「這個佈置很有****藝術感 / 美感****。」

****artistic = 具有藝術創作能力、審美能力或藝術氣質的****

Important:

> artistic person
> = 有藝術天分的人

not simply:

> “an art-related person.”

20. **artistically = in an artistic way / from an artistic perspective — 在藝術上；富藝術感地**

Practice 39

> “The film is **artistically ambitious**.”

「這部電影在**藝術上**很有野心。」

Practice 40

> “The room was artistically decorated.”

「房間被佈置得很**有藝術感**。」

artistically = 從藝術角度 / 以有創意、美感的方式

21. **artistry = artistic skill — 藝術技巧；藝術造詣**

A useful family extension.

Practice 41

> “The painting shows extraordinary **artistry**.”

「這幅畫展現出非凡的**藝術技巧 / 藝術造詣**。」

Practice 42

> “I admire the artistry of the performance.”

「我很欣賞這場表演的**藝術造詣**。」

artistry = 創作或表演中展現出的高水平藝術技巧和美感

22. **work of art = exceptionally beautiful/skilful object (比喻延伸) — 精美得像藝術品的東西**

Beyond literal artworks, the phrase can be figurative.

Practice 43

> “That cake is a **work of art**.”

「那個蛋糕簡直是一件**藝術品般的傑作**。」

Practice 44

> “The building is a work of art.”

「這棟建築本身就是一件**藝術品**。」

work of art — figurative extension = 因設計、工藝或美感極出色而被形容為藝術品的東西

23. **state-of-the-art = 最先進的；最尖端的**

This is an extremely important lexicalized compound, despite not meaning “art” in the ordinary artistic sense.

Practice 45

> “The museum uses **state-of-the-art** lighting.”

「博物館使用**最先進的照明設備**。」

Practice 46

> “The laboratory has state-of-the-art technology.”

「實驗室配備**最尖端的科技**。」

state-of-the-art = 代表某領域目前最先進、最高技術水平的

Important learner warning:

> state-of-the-art ≠ 「藝術狀態」

It means:

> ****最先進的 / 最尖端的****

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: ****art vs artwork****

****art****

usually uncountable:

> “I like modern art.”

= 我喜歡現代藝術。

****artwork****

can mean:

- * an individual piece;
- * artworks collectively.

> “The gallery displayed new artwork.”

= 畫廊展示新藝術作品。

So:

> art = 藝術 / 藝術作品整體

> artwork = 藝術作品

Important distinction: ****art vs painting****

Your passage contains both.

****art****

broad category.

****painting****

one artistic medium or one painted artwork.

- > painting is art
- > but
- > not all art is painting.

Art also includes:

- * sculpture
- * photography
- * performance
- * installation
- etc.

Important distinction: **art vs craft**

art

often emphasizes creative/aesthetic expression.

craft

often emphasizes skilled making and technique.

But the boundary can overlap significantly.

- > art = 藝術
- > craft = 工藝 / 手藝

An object may be considered both.

Important distinction: **art vs design**

art

often emphasizes expression, interpretation, aesthetics.

design

usually emphasizes planning something to serve a purpose/function.

- > painting as art
- > furniture design

But many areas combine both.

Important distinction: **art vs skill**

skill

general learned ability.

art

when used figuratively, suggests subtle judgment, experience, and finesse.

> “There is a skill to negotiation.”

possible.

> “There is an art to negotiation.”

suggests something more nuanced and difficult to master.

Important distinction: **art vs the arts**

art

can mean artistic activity generally or visual art.

the arts

the collective creative disciplines.

> “She studies art.”

possibly visual art.

> “She works in the arts.”

= 她在藝術界工作。

Important distinction: **artist vs painter**

You just curated **paint**.

painter

specifically:

- * someone who creates paintings;
- * or an oil-painting tradesperson depending on context.

artist

broader:
can create visual art, music, performance, etc.

So:

> Monet = both a painter and an artist.

Important distinction: **artistic vs artificial**

A major learner trap because they look similar.

artistic

= related to art / showing artistic talent.

artificial

= man-made / not natural / fake.

> artistic design
> = 有藝術感的設計

> artificial flowers
> = 人造花

They are completely different words.

Important distinction: **artistic vs creative**

artistic

specifically connected with artistic ability/aesthetics.

creative

broader:

able to produce new/original ideas.

An engineer can be highly **creative** without being particularly **artistic**.

Important distinction: **artistry vs art**

art

the activity/field/work.

artistry

the skill and quality demonstrated in doing it.

> “I admire the art.”

= 我欣賞這門藝術 / 作品。

> “I admire the artistry.”

= 我欣賞其中展現的藝術技巧 / 造詣。

Important distinction: **fine art vs applied art**

fine art

primarily created for aesthetic/expressive purposes.

applied art

uses artistic principles in practical objects/design.

Examples:

> painting → fine art

> furniture/textile design → applied art

The boundary can be debated, but this is the useful learner distinction.

Important distinction: **liberal arts vs fine arts**

liberal arts

broad academic education involving humanities, social sciences, etc.

fine arts

visual/creative artistic disciplines.

So:

> liberal arts ≠ fine arts

This is a high-value vocabulary trap.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **art — creative activity/expression** = 藝術
- * **art — visual art** = 美術 / 視覺藝術
- * **art — artworks collectively** = 藝術作品
- * **work of art** = 一件藝術作品
- * **art — skill/technique** = 技巧 / 技藝
- * **the art of** =的藝術 / 技巧
- * **art — learned craft** = 技藝
- * **the arts** = 各類藝術 / 藝術界
- * **visual arts** = 視覺藝術
- * **performing arts** = 表演藝術
- * **fine art(s)** = 美術 / 純藝術
- * **applied arts** = 應用藝術
- * **liberal arts** = 博雅教育 / 人文通識學科
- * **martial arts** = 武術
- * **art form** = 藝術形式
- * **artist — creator** = 藝術家
- * **artist — performer** = 藝人 / 表演者
- * **artistic — relating to art** = 藝術的
- * **artistic — talented/aesthetic** = 有藝術天分 / 有美感

****artistically**** = 在藝術上 / 富藝術感地
****artistry**** = 藝術技巧 / 造詣
****work of art — figurative**** = 精美得像藝術品的作品
****state-of-the-art**** = 最先進 / 最尖端

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
art — broad	透過創造力、技巧和想像表達思想、情感或美感的活動 / 領域
art — visual	以繪畫、雕塑、攝影等視覺形式為主的藝術
art — artworks collectively	藝術家創作出的藝術作品作為整體
work of art	一件個別的藝術創作
art — skill	需要經驗、判斷和細膩技巧才能掌握的能力
the art of	把某件事情做得熟練、細緻、恰到好處的技巧
the arts	音樂、戲劇、舞蹈、視覺藝術、文學等藝術領域整體
visual arts	主要透過視覺形式呈現的藝術
performing arts	透過現場 / 表演形式呈現的藝術
fine art(s)	主要以審美、創意和藝術表達為目的的純藝術 / 美術
applied arts	把藝術設計應用於具有實際用途物件上的藝術
liberal arts	強調廣泛人文、社會科學等基礎教育的博雅學科
martial arts	格鬥、防身或戰鬥技巧體系；武術
art form	具有自身方法、風格和傳統的一種藝術表達形式
artist — creator	創作藝術作品的人
artist — performer	從事音樂或其他創意表演的藝人 / 表演者
artistic — relational	與藝術創作、藝術家或藝術活動有關的
artistic — talent/aesthetic	具有藝術創作能力、審美能力或藝術氣質的
artistry	創作 / 表演中展現出的高水平藝術技巧和美感
state-of-the-art	代表某領域目前最高、最先進技術水平的

For your original passage

You have two especially useful source contexts:

> “an ****art book**** in the library”

Here:

****art** = 視覺藝術 / 美術這個領域

So:

> ****art book** = 藝術 / 美術書

And:

> “**Art** is deeply personal...”

Here:

****art = 藝術創作及藝術作品整體****

Natural translation:

> **「藝術本身很主觀、很個人化。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****art**** → 藝術 / 美術
- > ****art**** → 藝術作品整體
- > ****art**** → 技巧 / 技藝
- > ****the art of conversation**** → 談話技巧
- > ****the arts**** → 藝術界 / 各類藝術
- > ****artist**** → 藝術家 / 藝人
- > ****artistic**** → 藝術的 / 有藝術天分的
- > ****artistry**** → 藝術造詣
- > ****liberal arts**** → 博雅學科，不是「藝術科」
- > ****martial arts**** → 武術
- > ****state-of-the-art**** → 最先進的